Maria Milosh

Computational Social Scientist &
Democratic Innovations Researcher

mmilosh@uchicago.edu

Researcher specializing in citizens' assemblies and democratic innovations, with experience in experiment design, mixed-methods program evaluation, and quantitative policy analysis.

EDUCATION

University of Chicago 2020 - 2022
MSc in Computational Analysis & Public Policy

- Selected courses: Advanced Statistics, Causal Inference, Machine Learning, Discrete Math, Algorithms, Databases, Development Economics, Experimental Economics, Microeconomics
- Teaching assistant for Programming I, Databases, Political Economy courses

Higher School of Economics 2015 - 2019
BA in Political Science

- Teaching assistant for Big Data for Social Sciences, Qualitative Methods

SKILLS

Mixed-methods research
Evidence synthesis
Survey research
Comparative analysis
Experiments, causal inference

Python · R · SQL · Git/GitHub
Data cleaning and harmonization
Reproducible analysis
Data visualization

Citizens' assemblies
Democratic innovations
Deliberative democracy
Collective decision-making

English, Russian - fluent
French, Ukrainian - advanced

EXPERIENCE

Pre-Doctoral Student
Data & Democracy Lab, Data Science Institute at the University of Chicago Since May 2026

- Research on social choice and segregation in networks.

Research Contributor
People Powered May 2025 - Mar 2026

- Co-authored Impacts of Citizens' Assemblies, a comparative evidence review synthesizing over 70 studies of citizens' assemblies and their individual, societal, and institutional impacts.
- Synthesized evidence on participant learning, opinion change, public attitudes, institutional response, and implementation; developed research and practice recommendations and identified methodological gaps in existing evaluations.

Evaluation Researcher
Mozilla Foundarion AI & Democracy Cohort 2026-2027

- Designed an evaluation framework for an AI-supported deliberation tool to measure changes in participant self-reflection, reasoning, and deliberative quality.
- Developed quantitative and qualitative outcome measures and an experimental design using pre- and post-intervention surveys and observation data.

Adjunct Faculty
Bard College, NY 2026

- Designed and teach Civic Technology & Algorithms for Social Good, covering normative, technical, and evaluation approaches to public-interest technology.

City Research Scientist / Data Scientist
NYC Office of Labor Policy & Standards June 2022–Mar 2025

- Conducted quantitative research supporting implementation and evaluation of NYC local laws, including analysis of surveys,

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Impacts of Citizens' Assemblies: A Summary of Latest Research, with Ryan Gem. People Powered. January 2026.

Democracy narratives: what are they and how do they matter for democratic engagement and behavior?, with Ryan Gem, Rushikesh Jadhav, Aby Dwi Prasetya, Mareike Schomerus. People Powered and Busara. February 2026.

Unmasking Partisanship: Polarization Undermines Public Response to Collective Risk with M. Painter, K. Sonin, D. Van Dijcke, A. Wright. Journal of Public Economics, 2021.

Clustering Propensity: Measuring Segregation in Networks. Aksakal, Duchin, Milosh, Stephenson. Working paper, 2026.

DEMOCRATIC INNOVATION ENGAGEMENT

Chicago Climate Action Museum Assembly 2026
Contributing to early-stage process and design.

European Citizens' Panel on Democratic Resilience 2026
Academic observer of deliberation and facilitation at the assembly on democratic resilience.

Cornell Center on Global Democracy
Non-Resident Fellow 2026

commentary and public discussions of changes to the City Charter.
- Built reproducible pipelines and statistical analysis from multiple data sources and translated results into dashboards and policy analysis used by legal and policy teams.

Data Science Intern
World Bank, Development Impact Evaluation Mar 2021–Sept 2021

- Supported impact evaluation design and econometric analysis of World Bank policy interventions.
- Built data and NLP pipelines to analyze heterogeneous survey questionnaires, classify questions by topic and relevance, and improve comparability and access across survey instruments.
- Developed reproducible Python and GitHub workflows for survey research and data sharing across research teams.

Research Assistant
Becker Friedman Institute for Economics June 2019–Sept 2020

- Conducted econometric analysis on public policy interventions and civic engagement using international microdata, social media data, survey research
- Co-authored study on polarization and local policy in the Journal of Public Economics
- Managed data collection and analysis for international development projects